garbageman! With a yarmulke! And I just stopped and stared, because I couldn't believe it. We don't do that kind of work!"

Of course the garbageman was Jewish, in a country where 80 per cent of the population is Jewish. But she came from a world where Jews were overwhelmingly educated middle-class professionals, like her own family. The garbageman didn't fit her lived experience.

The same disconnect exists in much of the discussion taking place today in New York and London. Diaspora Jews, particularly younger ones, increasingly view the occupation as a moral outrage and worry about its corroding influence—not only on Israel's democracy, but on its society and culture. You see this in the outpouring of "liberal Zionist" commentary, in the rise of lobby groups like J Street fighting the status quo, and in the discussions that take place at *shul* and around Shabbat tables.

Their initial premise, however, is an idealized Israel, the egalitarian society of hardy, secular pioneers striving for peace with their neighbors, the outmatched David who won miraculous battles against the Arab Goliath. This rosy impression isn't confined to American Jews. President Obama, in a Shabbat address at a Washington synagogue in 2015, described his own first impressions of the country. "I came to know Israel as a young man through these incredible images of *kibbutzim*, and Moshe Dayan, and Golda Meir, and Israel overcoming incredible odds in the '67 war," he said. "The notion of pioneers who set out not only to safeguard a nation, but to remake the world. Not only to make the desert bloom, but to allow their values to flourish; to ensure that the best of Judaism would thrive."[8]

As the Jewish community has become more assimilated, support for Israel has become a central marker of Jewish identity. In a separate poll, conducted in 2016, Pew asked both American and Israeli Jews what it meant to be Jewish. A majority of the American Jews chose "leading an ethical and moral life" and "working for justice and equality". Among their number, 43 per cent also said that caring about Israel was an essential part of Jewishness. Just 19 per cent chose "observing Jewish law", which ranked well below "having a good sense of humor". The Israelis, on the other hand, couldn't seem to agree on an answer: the only choice that elicited majority support was "remembering the Holocaust".[9]

The diaspora, in other words, is engaged in self-projection. It views Israel as a reflection of itself: liberal, moral, committed to social justice. And thus the occupation of 1967 is viewed as a singularly corrupting force, a misstep